

Claude Terminal

Quick Start Guide

Version 0.5.0

Welcome

Welcome to Claude Terminal - a visual, user-friendly desktop interface for Claude CLI. This guide will help you get started quickly and make the most of all available features.

Prerequisites

Before using Claude Terminal, ensure you have:

1. Claude CLI installed and configured

- Install via: <https://claude.ai/download>
- Or run: `npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-cli`
- Authenticate: `claude auth login` in your terminal
- Verify installation: `claude --version`

2. Claude Pro subscription

Required for CLI access

Getting Started

First Launch

Step 1: Launch the Application

Open Claude Terminal. You will see a welcome screen.

Step 2: Authentication

Choose one of two authentication methods:

- **CLI Authentication (Recommended):** If you have already run `claude auth login`
- **Manual API Key:** Enter your API key from your Anthropic account

Step 3: Select a Project Folder

- Click "Select Project Folder"

- Choose your working directory
 - Claude will have read/write access to this folder only
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Interface Overview

Left Sidebar

File Tree

- Click folders to expand or collapse
- Click files to preview with syntax highlighting
- Right-click for context menu (create, rename, delete)

Search Files

- Filter files by name in real-time

Git Status Indicators

- M (orange) = Modified
- A (green) = Added
- U (blue) = Untracked
- D (red) = Deleted
- R (purple) = Renamed

Refresh Git Status Button

- Click to update status after making changes

Main Chat Area

Conversation Interface

- Type messages in the input box at bottom
- Press Enter to send
- Press Shift+Enter for new line
- Real-time streaming responses
- Full markdown and code block support

Top Header

Menu Button (☰)

- Toggle sidebar visibility

Settings Button (⚙)

- Access theme preferences

Help Button (?)

- View commands and keyboard shortcuts
 - Keyboard shortcut: Ctrl+/ (Cmd+/ on Mac)
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Key Features

File Operations

Preview Files

- Click any file to view with syntax highlighting
- Supports text files and images
- Performance limits: 1MB for text, 10MB for images

Create Files and Folders

- Right-click in file tree
- Select "New File" or "New Folder"
- Enter name and confirm

Rename Items

- Right-click item
- Select "Rename"
- Enter new name

Delete Items

- Right-click item
- Select "Delete"
- Confirm deletion

Search Files

- Use search box to filter by name
- Results update in real-time

Conversation Management

Automatic Saving

- Conversations save automatically per project

Archive History

- Saves conversation to archive file
- Clears display while preserving Claude's context
- Recommended every 150-200 messages

Clear History

- Deletes conversation history

- Cannot be undone

Performance Warnings

- Alerts appear at 150+ messages
- Helps maintain optimal performance

Theme System

Six Color Schemes Available:

1. Claude Classic - Original beige and cream tones
2. Light - Clean white interface
3. Dark - Dark mode for low-light environments
4. Forest - Green nature-inspired palette
5. Ocean - Cool blue tones
6. Sunset - Warm red and orange hues

Accessing Themes

- Click Settings button (⚙) in header
- Select desired theme
- Changes apply immediately
- Preference persists across sessions

Tool Permissions

First-Time Permission Request

When Claude needs to use a tool:

- Permission prompt appears
- Review the action
- Click "Approve" to allow
- Click "Deny" to reject

Subsequent Use

- Once approved, tools work automatically for the session
- All operations sandboxed to project directory

CLI Integration

Built on Claude CLI

- Full access to Claude CLI features
 - File operations, bash commands, and more
 - Maintains conversation context
 - Real-time streaming responses
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Common Tasks

Starting a Conversation

- 1. Ensure project folder is selected
- 2. Type your message
- 3. Press Enter to send

Switching Projects

- 1. Click "Change Project" in sidebar
- 2. Select new folder
- 3. Previous history automatically saved

Using Git Status

- 1. Initialize git: `git init`
- 2. Status indicators appear automatically
- 3. Click "Refresh Git Status" after changes

Previewing Files

- 1. Click file in tree
- 2. Preview modal opens
- 3. View with syntax highlighting
- 4. Press Esc or click X to close

Creating Files

- 1. Right-click folder in tree
- 2. Select "New File" or "New Folder"
- 3. Enter name
- 4. Item created immediately

Reference

Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+/ (Cmd+ /)	Toggle help modal
Enter	Send message
Shift+Enter	New line in message
Esc	Close modal windows

Slash Commands

Use these commands in the chat:

- `/help` - Show help information
- `/clear` - Clear conversation history
- `/exit` - Exit current conversation
- `/fast` - Toggle fast mode
- `/new` - Start new conversation
- `/tokens` - Show token usage
- `/version` - Show Claude version

Available Skills

Built-in skills you can invoke:

- `/ask` - Request user input during execution
- `/bash` - Run shell commands
- `/edit` - Edit files with smart diffs
- `/grep` - Search within file contents
- `/plan` - Create implementation plans
- `/read` - Read file contents
- `/task` - Manage task lists
- `/web` - Fetch web content
- `/write` - Write new files

Type `/help skills` in chat for complete list.

Troubleshooting

"No project selected" Error

Solution:

- Click "Select Project" button in sidebar
- Choose a valid folder

"No API key configured" Error

Solution:

- Use CLI authentication if logged in via `claude auth login`
- Or enter API key from anthropic.com in settings

Claude CLI Not Found

Solution:

1. Install: `npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-cli`

2. Authenticate: `claude auth login`
3. Restart Claude Terminal

File Tree Not Loading

Possible causes:

- Missing read permissions on folder
- Folder does not exist
- Try selecting a different folder

Git Status Not Showing

Solution:

1. Initialize git: `git init`
2. Make file changes
3. Click "Refresh Git Status"

Performance Issues

Solution:

- Archive conversation history
- Or clear history to start fresh
- Keep message count under 200 for best performance

Theme Not Applying

Solution:

- Switch themes back and forth
- Restart application if needed

Tips for Success

1. Use Git

Initialize git in your projects to enable file status indicators

2. Archive Regularly

Archive conversation history every 150-200 messages

3. Preview First

Preview files before asking Claude to edit them

4. Explore Context Menus

Right-click throughout the interface for additional options

5. Use Dark Mode

Enable Dark theme for comfortable night coding

6. Learn Shortcuts

Master Ctrl+/ for quick access to help

What's New in v0.5.0

File Explorer Enhancements

- File preview with syntax highlighting
- File search and filter
- Git status indicators with refresh
- Context menu file operations

Customization

- Theme system with 6 color schemes
- Settings modal for preferences

User Experience

- Conversation history archiving
 - Tool permissions system
 - Performance warnings
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Support

For issues, questions, or feedback:

- Report bugs on GitHub
 - Consult Claude CLI documentation at docs.anthropic.com/claude
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Thank you for using Claude Terminal!